

OPERATION COPPER LANTERN

SCENARIO TITLE: OPERATION COPPER LANTERN

DATE: 03 OCT 1985

DIRECTOR BRIEF:

During Black Sea fleet maneuvers, NATO observes a submarine rendezvous, coastal tracking bursts, an unusual cargo flight, and reports involving a third-country intelligence service. The pattern may signal covert technology transfer, a counterintelligence trap, or preparations for regional coercion.

OBJECTIVE:

Determine the most likely purpose of the coordinated activity and whether NATO should expose, monitor, or disrupt it. Identify the evidence that would most change the assessment.

HANDLING NOTE

This document contains fictional facts for a multi-agent training game. Each marked dossier is routed only to its named specialist. Facts should not be supplemented with outside knowledge.

[SUBMARINE DOSSIER]

- [p. 2] A Soviet diesel submarine surfaced at night outside its declared exercise lane and met a civilian-registered support vessel for twenty-three minutes.
- [p. 2] Infrared imagery shows a crane moving one container-sized object toward the submarine, but cloud obscures the final position.
- [p. 2] The submarine later resumed its published exercise route and transmitted a routine machinery-status message.
- [p. 2] The support vessel has previously serviced oceanographic projects and naval auxiliaries.
- You have no access to ELINT, aircraft, or HUMINT reporting.

[ELINT DOSSIER]

- [p. 2] Coastal tracking radars illuminated the rendezvous area in short alternating sectors rather than maintaining continuous coverage.
- [p. 2] A low-power burst used a modulation associated with Soviet range-safety beacons, not combat guidance.
- [p. 2] One radar shut down six minutes before the civilian vessel arrived and resumed immediately after departure.
- [p. 2] The gap could be deliberate concealment, equipment cooling, or a scheduled handoff between stations.
- You have no access to submarine, aircraft, or HUMINT reporting.

[AIR DOSSIER]

- [p. 3] An An-12 cargo aircraft arrived from a third country and parked in a screened military apron for ninety minutes.
- [p. 3] The aircraft departed lighter according to runway-performance estimates, though wind uncertainty makes the weight calculation imprecise.
- [p. 3] A Soviet helicopter flew from the same airfield toward the coast but disappeared below radar coverage.
- [p. 3] No direct track connects the helicopter to the submarine rendezvous.
- You have no access to submarine, ELINT, or HUMINT reporting.

[HUMINT DOSSIER]

- [p. 3] A proven customs source says the foreign aircraft manifest listed oceanographic instruments with serial numbers that do not match the crates observed.
- [p. 3] A suspected double agent claims the Soviets are transferring a quiet-propulsion prototype to the third country.
- [p. 3] A separate embassy source reports the third country is returning defective sonar equipment purchased the previous year.
- [p. 3] The double agent knew the rendezvous date unusually early, raising the possibility of a controlled leak.
- You have no access to submarine, ELINT, or aircraft reporting.

[END DOSSIER]

END OF FICTIONAL SCENARIO